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Chapter 3: ICT Skills-I

1. What is ICT? Write any three examples of ICT tools.

Answer:

ICT stands for **Information and Communication Technology**. It refers to the use of digital technologies and communication tools to **create, store, process, share, and exchange information**. ICT has become an important part of our daily lives. We use it in education, communication, business, banking, healthcare, and entertainment.

Some common ICT tools are:

1. **Computer:** A computer is used to create documents, prepare presentations, store information, perform calculations, and complete many other tasks.
2. **Smartphone:** A smartphone allows us to communicate through calls and messages, access the Internet, attend online classes, and use different applications.
3. **Internet:** The Internet connects computers and other devices around the world. It helps us search for information, communicate with others, watch educational videos, and use online services.

Other examples of ICT tools include tablets, printers, email, video-conferencing applications, and digital cameras.

2. What is the difference between hardware and software?

Answer:

A computer system mainly consists of **hardware and software**. Both are necessary for a computer to work properly.

Hardware refers to the physical parts of a computer that we can **see and touch**. Examples include the keyboard, mouse, monitor, CPU, printer, and speakers.

Software refers to the **programs and instructions** that tell the computer what to do. Software cannot be physically touched. Examples include Windows, Microsoft Word, web browsers, and media players.

Hardware

Software

It consists of physical parts of a computer. It consists of programs and instructions.

It can be seen and touched.

It cannot be physically touched.

It may get damaged physically.

It may be affected by viruses or become corrupted.

Examples: Keyboard, mouse, monitor.

Examples: Windows, MS Word, Chrome.

For example, when we type a document, the **keyboard is hardware**, while **Microsoft Word is software** used to create and edit the document.

3. What is an operating system? Give two examples.

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Answer:

An **Operating System (OS)** is system software that manages the computer's hardware and software and provides an environment in which other applications can run. It acts as a link between the **user and the computer hardware**.

The operating system performs several important functions:

1. It manages computer hardware such as the **CPU, memory, keyboard, and printer**.
2. It helps users **open and use applications**.
3. It manages **files and folders** stored on the computer.
4. It controls the use of **system resources**.
5. It provides an interface through which users can interact with the computer.

Two examples of operating systems are:

- **Microsoft Windows**
- **Linux**

For example, when we switch on a computer, the operating system starts and provides the environment in which we can open applications such as a web browser or word processor.

4. What is the Internet? Mention any three uses of the Internet.

Answer:

The **Internet** is a worldwide network that connects millions of computers, smartphones, servers, and other devices. It allows people to communicate, access information, and use various online services from almost anywhere.

The Internet is very useful in our everyday lives. Some important uses are:

1. **Education:** Students can search for information, attend online classes, read digital books, watch educational videos, and use learning websites.
2. **Communication:** People can communicate with friends, teachers, family members, and colleagues through email, messaging, and video calls.
3. **Entertainment:** People can watch videos, listen to music, play online games, and access other forms of digital entertainment.
4. **Online services:** The Internet allows people to use services such as online banking, ticket booking, shopping, and bill payments.
5. **Information:** We can quickly find news, weather information, articles, maps, and other useful information.

Therefore, the Internet has made communication, learning, and access to information much easier and faster.

5. What is email? Write any three advantages of using email.

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Answer:

Email, or **electronic mail**, is a method of sending and receiving digital messages through the Internet. An email can contain text as well as attachments such as documents, images, presentations, and other files.

For example, a student can send an assignment to a teacher through email without physically submitting a printed copy.

Some advantages of email are:

1. **Fast communication:** Messages can reach the receiver within a very short time, even if the receiver is far away.
2. **Low cost:** Sending an email is generally inexpensive compared with sending a physical letter.
3. **File attachments:** We can attach documents, images, presentations, and other files to an email.
4. **Easy to store:** Emails can be stored digitally and accessed later when needed.
5. **Convenient:** We can send and receive emails from computers, smartphones, and tablets.

Thus, email is a fast, convenient, and useful method of digital communication.

6. A student wants to prepare a school project using a computer. Name three ICT tools or applications that can help the student and explain their uses.

Answer:

A student can use different ICT tools and applications to prepare an attractive and informative school project. Three useful tools are:

1. Microsoft Word:

Microsoft Word is a word-processing application. The student can use it to **write and format the project**, add headings, paragraphs, tables, pictures, and page numbers. It can also be used to check spelling and make the project look organised.

2. Microsoft PowerPoint:

PowerPoint is a presentation application. The student can use it to create **slides containing text, images, charts, diagrams, and other visual information**. It is especially useful when the student has to present the project in front of the class.

3. Internet/Web Browser:

A web browser such as Chrome or Edge can be used to **search for information** related to the project. The student can find articles, educational resources, images, and other relevant information. However, information found online should be checked carefully and taken from reliable sources.

For example, if a student is preparing a project on **climate change**, they could use a web browser to research the topic, Microsoft Word to prepare a detailed written report, and PowerPoint to present the main points to the class.

Using these ICT tools together can make the project **informative, organised, creative, and easier to present**.

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